
06 RCA

Business Analysis Deliverable

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Status: Final portfolio case study

Method: Period-aligned comparison + segmentation + operational signal review + evidence classification

1. Problem statement

South revenue declined 2.1% from Q3 to Q4. SLA achievement fell 9.7 percentage points and support tickets/order increased +32.8%. The question is whether service deterioration is a contributor to the commercial decline and retention concern.

2. Evidence register

ID	Source	Evidence	Period / aggregation
E-001	Sales dataset	1,200 rows covering Jan-Dec 2025; fields include revenue, orders, customers, cancellations, SLA achievement and support tickets.	Full connected dataset
E-002	Overall revenue	Q3 revenue ■1,471,427; Q4 revenue ■1,447,831; movement -1.6%.	All regions, Q3->Q4
E-003	South revenue	Q3 revenue ■485,975; Q4 revenue ■475,859; movement -2.1%.	South, Q3->Q4
E-004	South SLA	SLA achievement 81.6% in Q3 to 71.9% in Q4, a -9.7 percentage-point movement.	South, Q3->Q4
E-005	South support pressure	Support tickets/order 0.075 to 0.099, a +32.8% movement.	South, Q3->Q4
E-006	South product mix	Cloud Suite -11.0%; Analytics Pro -10.5%; CRM Platform -4.3%; Security Plus +27.1%.	South, Q3->Q4
E-007	South segment mix	SMB -21.6%; Mid-Market -18.5%; Enterprise +38.0%.	South, Q3->Q4
E-008	South channel mix	Direct -11.7%; Online -5.7%; Partner +15.9%.	South, Q3->Q4

ID	Source	Evidence	Period / aggregation
E-009	Cancellation evidence	Only 1 recorded cancellation exists in the connected dataset. This is insufficient for a customer-level causal analysis.	Full connected dataset
E-010	Business context	Management evidence identifies South as a priority area and raises delivery/SLA and cancellation concerns. Customer-level linkage is required before causal interpretation.	Business documents

3. Hypothesis assessment

ID	Hypothesis	Status	Evidence	Interpretation
H-01	South service deterioration contributed to the revenue decline.	Partially supported	E-003,E-004,E-005,E-010	Revenue and service moved adversely in the same period; no causal linkage.
H-02	Cloud Suite decline is a material commercial contributor in South.	Supported as contribution signal	E-006	Revenue declined Q3->Q4; absolute impact should be reviewed before intervention.
H-03	SMB/Mid-Market weakness contributes to South decline.	Supported as contribution signal	E-007	Both segments declined; Enterprise growth offsets part of the pressure.
H-04	Direct/Online weakness contributes to South decline.	Supported as contribution signal	E-008	Both channels declined; Partner growth offsets part of the pressure.
H-05	SLA breaches are causing cancellations.	Unvalidated	E-009,E-010	Only one cancellation is available and no customer/order linkage is present.

4. Root-cause conclusion

No root cause is confirmed. The strongest current operational hypothesis is service-performance deterioration because it is period-aligned with the South decline and supported by business context. This remains a hypothesis, not a causal finding.

5. Validation plan

- Obtain customer/order-level cancellation records and reasons.
- Obtain SLA breach events and affected orders.
- Join service and cancellation records on a common customer/order key where permitted.
- Compare cancellation rates for breached versus unaffected orders/customers.
- Check whether service events precede cancellation events.
- Segment results by product, customer segment, region and channel.

6. Investigation outcome

The current analysis establishes where to investigate, what evidence supports the hypothesis and what evidence is missing. The appropriate next action is targeted validation rather than a blanket commercial intervention.